Arts University Bournemouth (AUB)

Fees Payment Policy 2026/27

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1. Purpose

This policy sets out the framework governing tuition fee liability, payment expectations, refunds, and escalation procedures at Arts University Bournemouth (AUB). It ensures transparency for students and compliance with consumer protection legislation, Competition and Markets Authority (CMA) guidance, and regulatory expectations.

It applies to all tuition, accommodation, library, and miscellaneous charges payable to AUB. The policy aims to ensure transparency, fairness, and responsible financial management while minimizing student debt.

2. Scope

This policy outlines the financial obligations of students at Arts University Bournemouth (AUB) and applies to all students enrolled on AUB provision including foundation, undergraduate, postgraduate, online, short course, and exchange programmes.

3. Principles

AUB administers fee collection according to the following principles:

- Transparency of information prior to enrolment
- Fair and consistent application of procedures
- Compliance with consumer and contract law
- Proportionate escalation of non-payment actions
- Consideration of individual circumstances where engagement occurs

4. Fee Liability

Students become liable for tuition fees upon enrolment or acceptance of terms as defined within their student contract. Liability applies regardless of third-party sponsorship or funding delays.

5. Fee Review and Variation

AUB reviews its Fees Payment Policy annually and may amend it when necessary to reflect regulatory, financial, or operational changes. Tuition fees may also be adjusted in line with inflation and/or as permitted by the UK Government, including changes to the maximum fee for Home Undergraduate degrees. If such changes take effect, the tuition fees you pay in future years of study may differ from those you paid in your current year.

6.Tuition Fee Categories

Tuition fee levels are determined by student residency status and course type.

Student Status

- **Home Students:** Tuition fees are set in accordance with UK Government regulations. AUB reserves the right to charge up to the maximum fee permitted under those regulations.
- **International Students:** Tuition fees are determined by AUB and are reviewed annually. Fee levels may vary between academic years and will be confirmed in offer documentation.
- **Channel Islands and Isle of Man Students:** Students from the Channel Islands and Isle of Man are charged tuition fees in line with Home fee structures.

Foundation Courses

- Home students who are under 19 years of age on 31 August in the year of course commencement are not required to pay tuition fees.
- Students aged 19 or over, or those classified as International or Channel Islands and Isle of Man, are required to pay tuition fees.
- Additional charges may apply for materials, resources, or registration, and these will be communicated in advance where relevant.

Higher Education Courses (Full-time and Part-time)

All students enrolled on Higher Education programmes are liable for tuition fees for each academic year of study, regardless of mode of attendance.

Details of applicable fee levels are published on the AUB website and confirmed in individual offer documentation. For detailed tuition fee structures, visit:

Foundation Fees
Undergraduate Fees
Postgraduate Fees
Research Fees

7.Student Loans Company (SLC) Funding

- **Undergraduate Tuition Fee Loans**: Tuition fee loans provided by the Student Loans Company (SLC) for undergraduate study are paid directly to AUB on behalf of the student.

- **Maintenance Loans:** Maintenance loans are paid directly to students by the SLC and are intended to support living costs. These funds are not applied toward tuition fees by AUB.
- **Postgraduate Loans:** For Master's and Postgraduate Research students, SLC funding is paid directly to the student. Students are responsible for ensuring that tuition fees are paid to AUB in accordance with the published payment schedule.
- Students remain ultimately responsible for the payment of their tuition fees in full, regardless of the timing or status of SLC payments.

  For further information please visit: SLC Website

8. Payment Arrangements

AUB operates a cashless payment environment. Payments must be made via authorised online platforms. Instalment arrangements are communicated at enrolment and must be adhered to unless amended by agreement. Links to Payment portals are given as below:

- Home & Online Students: Open Payment Pathway
- International & Online Students: International Payment Portal
- Short Courses: AUB Online Store

Students from sanctioned countries must complete **a Pre-Payment Advice form** before transferring funds.

9. Deposits

Deposits listed as below will be required to secure a place or meet visa sponsorship requirements. Deposit conditions and refundability are communicated at offer stage. AUB reserves the right to change deposit requirements.

- **International Students (CAS Required):** Deposit of one term's tuition fees.
- **Nigeria & Pakistan Nationals:** 50% of the full-year fee before CAS issuance.
- **International Masters students:** £500 non-refundable acceptance deposit.
- **Online Masters students:** £500 non-refundable acceptance fee.
- **US Federal Aid / Government Loan Recipients:** £500 non-refundable deposit (paid directly to AUB).
- **Students with Financial Guarantee Letters:** No deposit required.

10.Payment Deadlines

Undergraduate & Postgraduate On-Campus Students

- Termly instalments (3 equal payments): Due at the start of each term.

Online Masters Students

- Fees are payable in full at the start of the course. In exceptional circumstances, payment may be made in three equal instalments where this has been agreed in advance with AUB.
- Students will not be able to enrol on the course until they have paid the £500 non-refundable acceptance fee. Students have up to the end of the first taught week to pay the acceptance fee and enrol on the course.

Short Courses / Summer Courses

- Fees in full due at the time of booking.

Study Abroad

- Full payment upfront (or pre-arranged instalments in exceptional circumstances).

Accommodation Fees

- Termly payments as per the tenancy agreement.

11. Refunds and Withdrawals

Refund eligibility is determined by withdrawal timing relative to teaching activity. Administrative deductions may apply. Refund rights are communicated clearly before enrolment. Accommodation refunds are governed separately by tenancy agreements.

- **On-campus provision :**Tuition fee liability is calculated based on the number of academic terms attended. A student is deemed to have attended a term once the first taught week of that term has been completed.
- **Online MA (two-year provision):** Tuition fee liability is calculated based on the number of units commenced. A student is deemed to have commenced a unit once the first taught week of that unit has been completed.
- **International Administrative Fee:** An administrative charge of **£750** applies to international students who withdraw during Term 1.
- **Visa Refusal Refunds:** Refunds following visa refusal are subject to a **£100 administrative fee**. An additional charge of up to **£1,500** may apply where the

refusal results from incorrect or incomplete information provided by the student or where the student declines their place at AUB.

- **Short Course Refunds:** A full refund will be issued if withdrawal occurs within **14 days of accepting the course offer** (statutory cooling-off period).
- A full refund will also be issued where withdrawal occurs **30 days or more prior to the course start date**.

Scholarships, Bursaries and Fee Waivers

AUB offers a range of scholarships, bursaries, discounts, and fee incentives. Eligibility criteria, application processes, and full terms are published on the AUB website and may vary by academic year.

- **International Students:** Eligible students may apply for AUB scholarships. An **Early Payment Fee Waiver of £1,500** may be available where the full annual tuition fee is paid by 1 August. Further details are published under International Scholarships – see link International Scholarships. There is no progression discount for students repeating a year.

- **Post Graduate Students:** Alumni and other eligible applicants may qualify for progression fee discounts. Full details are available within the published Postgraduate Fees information. Postgraduate Fees.

- **Short Course Discounts:** Following discounts may apply, subject to availability and administered on a first-come basis:

    I. **20% discount** for one student per course from Bournemouth University (BU), Bournemouth & Poole College (BPC), or residents of the Innovation Studio

    II. **20% discount** for one AUB staff member per course

    III. **20% discount** for one child of a current staff member for Saturday Art School

All discounts are subject to eligibility verification and may not be combined unless explicitly stated.

12. Escalation Process in Case of non-Payment

On-Campus, BA Online, and Postgraduate Online (30-week and 105-week programmes)

Where tuition or accommodation fees remain unpaid, AUB will follow a staged escalation process. Communications will normally be issued via multiple channels including email, text message, and student portal notifications.

International students - If the fees detailed in the schedule below remain unpaid, your visa may be subject to curtailment.

Step	Tuition Fees Action	Accommodation Fees Action
1	28 days after start of course - Reminder Notice 1 issued (Email and Text)	14 days after Accommodation payment due date - Reminder Notice 1 issued (Email and Text)
2	14 days after Reminder Notice 1 - Reminder Notice 2 issued and Dashboard Notification applied	14 days after Reminder Notice 1 - Reminder Notice 2 issued and Dashboard Notification applied
3	14 days after Reminder Notice 2 - Final Notice issued (Email, Text, and Letter	14 days after Reminder Notice 2 Final Notice issued (Email, Text, and Letter)
4	7 days after Final Notice -Student barred from teaching and assessment activity	7 days after Final Notice - Accommodation removal procedures initiated
5	Referral to External Debt Collection Agency	Referral to External Debt Collection Agency

Online MA (Two-Year Programme)

Where tuition fees remain unpaid, the following staged process applies:

Step	Action
1	Day 8 — Reminder notice issued requesting immediate payment (Email and Text)
2	Day 15 — Second reminder notice issued requesting immediate payment (Email and Text)
3	Day 22 — Temporary block placed on the student account. Access will be restored once outstanding fees are settled

4	Two weeks after Day 22 — Student withdrawn from the course if payment remains outstanding

Students are strongly encouraged to contact the Finance Office at the earliest opportunity if they anticipate difficulty meeting payment obligations. Early engagement may allow alternative arrangements to be considered.

Additional Consequences of Outstanding Fees

- Students with unpaid fees will not normally be permitted to commence a subsequent term, re-enrol, graduate, or receive official academic documentation.
- Students sponsored under the **Student Route (formerly Tier 4)** visa may be withdrawn in line with UKVI compliance requirements, and changes to enrolment status may be reported to the Home Office where required.

Students are encouraged to contact the Finance Office as early as possible if they experience difficulty meeting payment obligations. Engagement may enable supportive arrangements to be considered prior to escalation.

Escalation actions are applied in accordance with institutional regulations and may affect progression, access to services, or contractual accommodation rights.

AUB recognises individual financial circumstances and will handle each case sensitively. Students facing financial difficulties should contact the Finance Office immediately at income@aub.ac.uk.

Exchange Programmes

- AUB students on an Exchange Programme must pay full AUB tuition fees.
- No additional tuition fees payable to the partner institution.
- Exchange students may qualify for Maintenance & Travel Grants – contact international@aub.ac.uk.

13. Governance and Monitoring

The Finance Department monitors policy application and reports material risks or deviations through institutional governance channels.